

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Vanessa shares some home truths.



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you often reflect on your past experiences?
- What have you learned about yourself?

Can Do Statements

- I can write a paragraph about personal experiences.
- I can express uncertainty about past events.
- I can talk about what happened, what has happened and what was happening.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa reflects on her time at Bistro 88.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

My time at Bistro 88 has tested me to the core. I have been forced to evaluate my working relationships and my own strengths and weaknesses as a restaurant manager. When I reflect on how I came to become responsible for Bistro 88, I realize that I was very much thrown into the deep end. I can't have been there more than a couple months before I was promoted to head chef. I was young, inexperienced and honestly, a little naive. I mustn't have fully understood what I was getting into. I needed to find my voice in the chaos and establish some clear expectations for the kitchen staff. Seeing the positive changes in the back of house, the owner, who had had enough of dealing with the day-to-day operations, offered me an opportunity of a lifetime.

The role of restaurant manager came with its own set of challenges. Moving to management required a shift in the way I approached staff and how I responded to situations in the workplace. I spent the next couple months weeding out incompetent waitstaff, developing guidelines for food preparation, and working with new suppliers. Importantly, I was determined to assemble a dynamic group of talented people who are genuinely interested in providing quality service to customers. I must have been working at least 60 hours a week during that time.

I can't have imagined when I entered the doors of Bistro 88, that I would be in the position I am after only one year. I have definitely grown as a person and am more confident in my own skills and abilities. It has been a stressful yet rewarding experience.





Let's Practice!

Vanessa writes about her past experiences.

Instructions: Use the phrases from Column B to complete the sentences in Column A. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. It has forced me to
2. I needed
3. Seeing the positive changes in the back of house, the owner, who had had enough of dealing with the day-to-day operations,
4. I was
5. The role of restaurant
6. Importantly, I was determined to assemble a dynamic group of talented people who were
7. It has been a

COLUMN B

- a. manager came with its own set of challenges.
- b. evaluate my working relationships and my own strengths and weaknesses as a restaurant manager.
- c. working at least 60 hours a week during that time.
- d. offered me an opportunity of a lifetime.
- e. stressful yet rewarding experience.
- f. genuinely interested in providing quality service to customers.
- g. to find my voice in the chaos.



Let's Practice!

Can you write about past uncertainties?

Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete the sentences. Use capital letters where necessary. There is one option that you don't need to use.

Word Bank

can't have imagined / can't have / must have been working / must have fully understood / can't have

1. I _____ been there more than a couple months before I was promoted to head chef.
2. I _____ what I was getting into.
3. I _____ at least 60 hours a week during that time.
4. I _____ when I entered the doors of Bistro 88, that I would be in the position I am after only one year.



Extension Activity

You can learn a lot from the experiences of others.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Interview a friend or family member about their work history.
- Then, write a 160-180 word paragraph about their personal experiences.
- What did they learn about themselves and others?
- Include a topic sentence and concluding sentence.
- Use different forms of the **Past tense** to describe what happened.
- When complete, read the paragraph aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I interview a friend or family member about their work history.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about their experiences.

☐ ☐

I write about the past.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to the very core** (expression): completely or totally
e.g. My time at Bistro 88 has tested me to the very core.
- **the deep end** (expression): placed into the middle of something challenging
e.g. I realize that I was very much thrown into the deep end.
- **chaos** (noun): complete confusion and disorder
e.g. I needed to find my voice in the chaos and establish some clear expectations for the kitchen staff.
- **to weed out** to remove people that are not wanted from a group: (verb)
e.g. I spent the next couple months weeding out incompetent waitstaff, developing guidelines for food preparation, and working with new suppliers.
- **shift** (noun): a change in position or direction
e.g. Moving to management required a shift in the way I approached staff and how I responded to situations in the workplace.





Learning Points

Writing Tip: Modals in the Past

Modals are “helping verbs” you can use in writing. You use modals when you want to express probability, possibility, or uncertainty. You can use modals to talk about the past, present, or future.

If you write about past events and you want to express uncertainty or probability in the past, modals can be used to do that. Using modals gives you an opportunity to develop your ideas and opinions.

Look at the chart for an outline of how to use modals to talk about the past:

Modal	Possibility	Example
must have	99% certain	<i>I must have worked at least 60 hours a week during that time.</i>
can't have	almost impossible (99%)	<i>I can't have imagined when I entered the doors of Bistro 88, that I would be in the position I am after only one year.</i>

Examples:

- *I can't have been there more than a couple of months before I was promoted to head chef.*
- *I mustn't have fully understood what I was getting into.*





Learning Points

Writing in the Past

You use a variety of past tenses and many other kinds of tenses when writing a narrative, like a biography.

Let's look at the uses of the **Simple Past**, the **Past Continuous** and the **Present Perfect**.

The Simple Past

You can use the **Simple Past** with an adverb of time to create a historical context of past events. Adverb phrases of time, such as yesterday, or a date, or specific time are used.

For example:

Michael Jackson died in 2009.

The Past Continuous

You use the **Past Continuous** to refer to a longer-lasting situation in the past.

For example:

Michael Jackson died in 2009 while he was living in California.

The Present Perfect

You can use the **Present Perfect** to connect past events to the present.

For example:

Michael Jackson has died. (He is no longer alive now.)

You do not refer to a specific time when you use the **Present Perfect**, but you can use adverbs of frequency.

For example:

I've always loved Michael Jackson's music.

Examples:

- *My time at Bistro 88 has tested me to the very core.*
- *I was working at least 60 hours a week during that time.*
- *I spent the next couple months weeding out incompetent waitstaff, developing guideline for food preparation, working with new suppliers.*

